Find a Friend: **The Digestive System Activity**

Teacher Instructions

This activity is good for consolidating or checking learning in a plenary or for revision.
Cards can be printed out A4 or A5 and laminated for repeated use.

How to use:

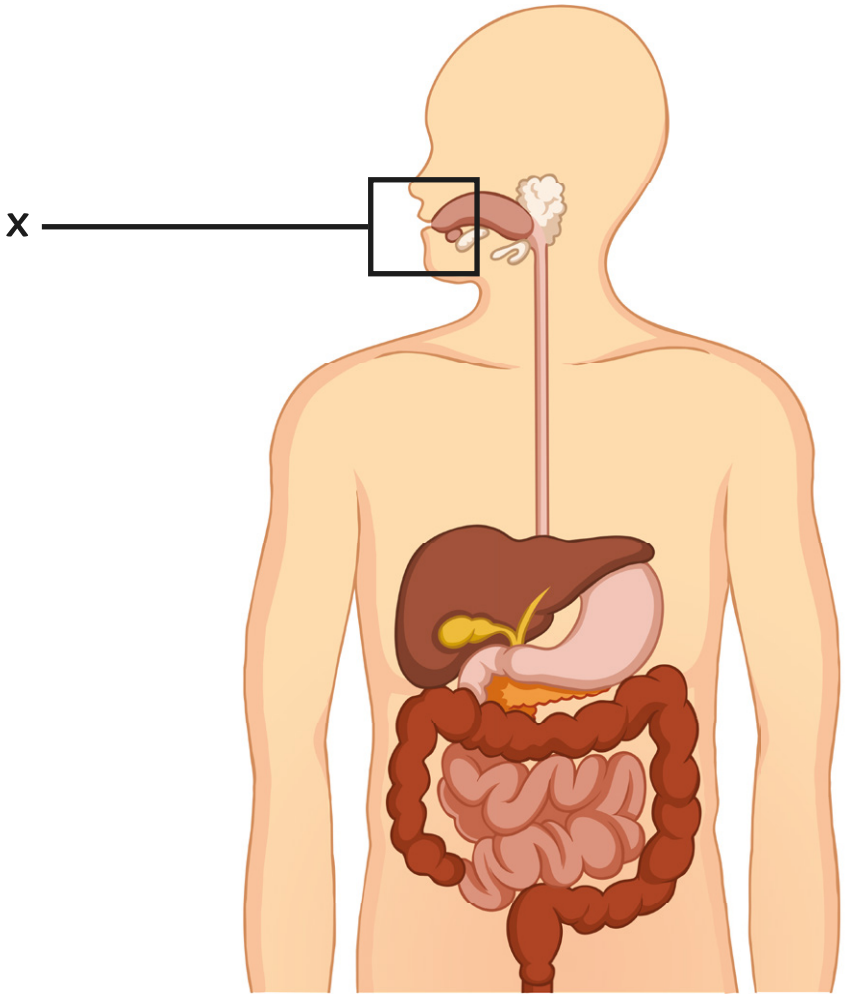
There are 3 types of card:

- orange - diagram (with a part labelled as X);
- blue - name of a part;
- green - description or function of a part.

Give each student in the class one of the cards. This can be random or differentiated by giving easier cards to weaker students and more tricky cards to higher ability students. Unused cards can be put onto a table for students to go to if they can't find their 'friends'. Where there are more students than cards, give one card to a pair of students.

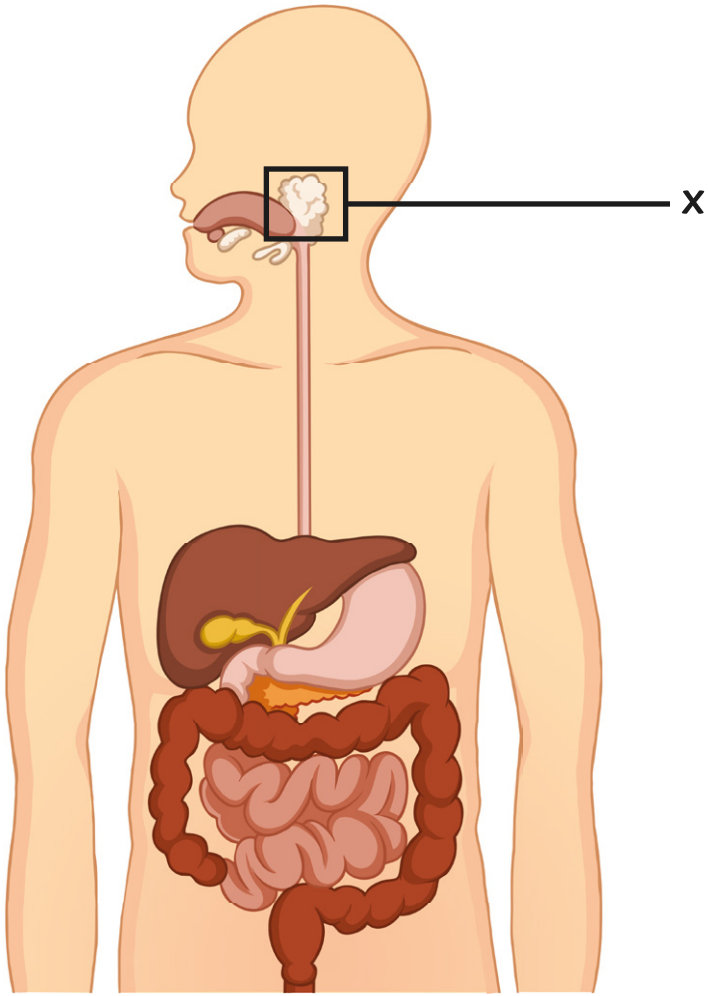
Students should then move around the room and find their two 'friends' with the matching diagram, name and function. This encourages discussion and students that are unsure can get help from their peers.

Once the students have found their friends, the cards can be stuck onto a board, wall or window to form a display that students can refer to if necessary.


X

Mouth

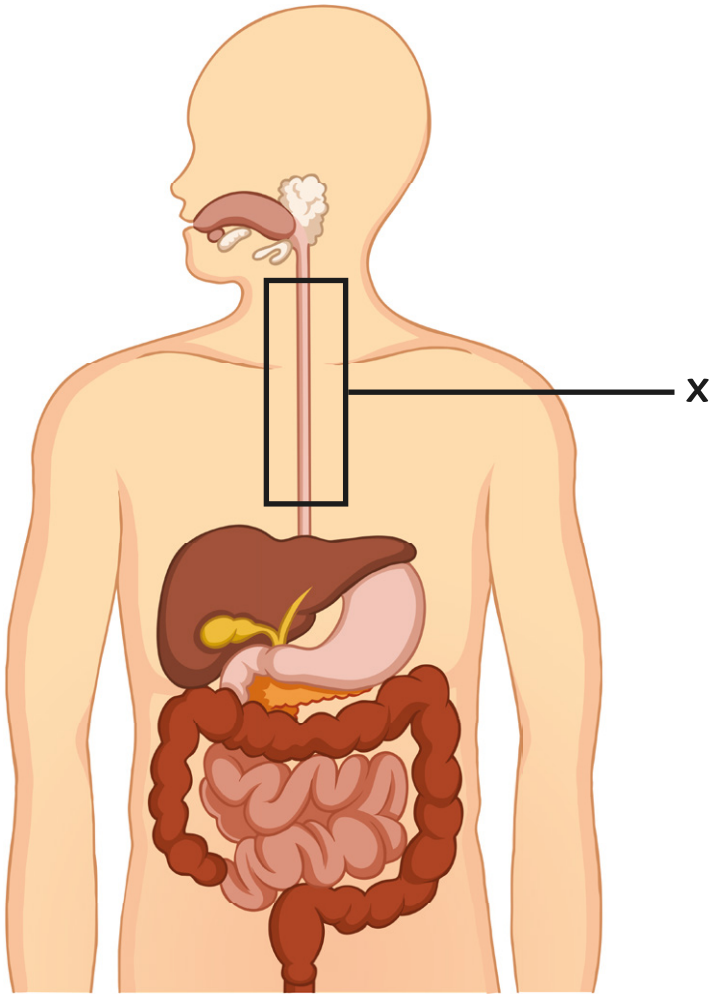
This is where digestion begins. Food is chewed into smaller pieces and mixed with saliva.


X

salivary glands

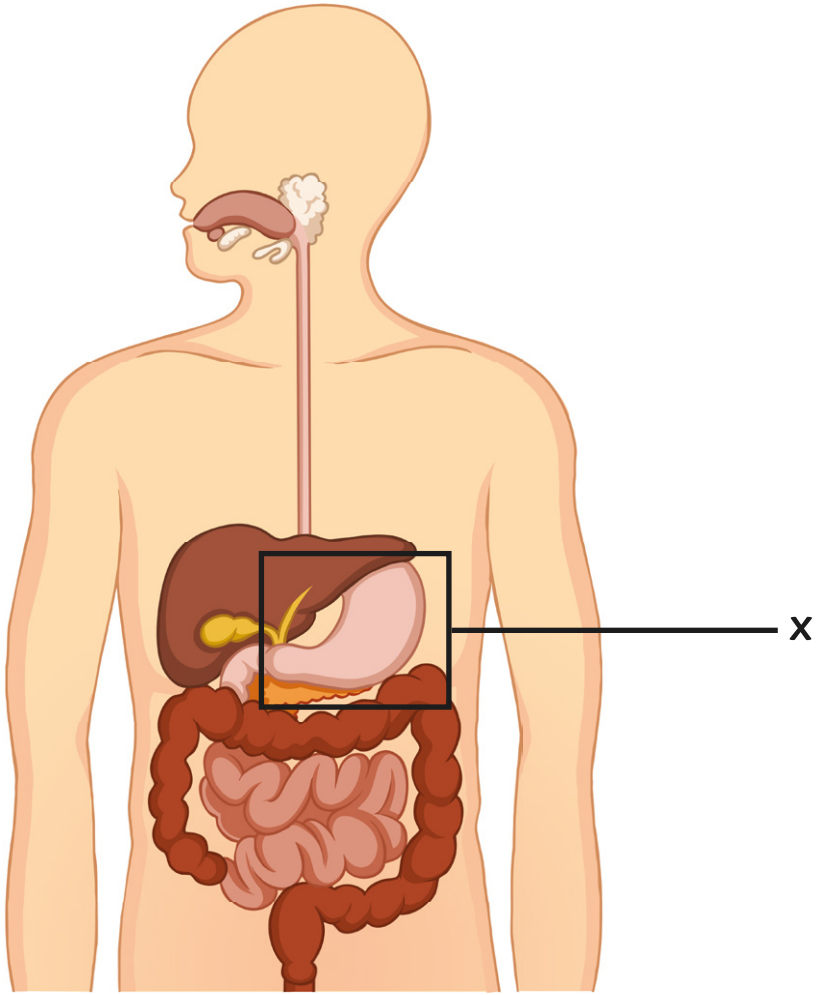
This is where saliva is produced.

The saliva makes food easier to swallow and contains amylase (an enzyme) that breaks down starch into glucose.


X

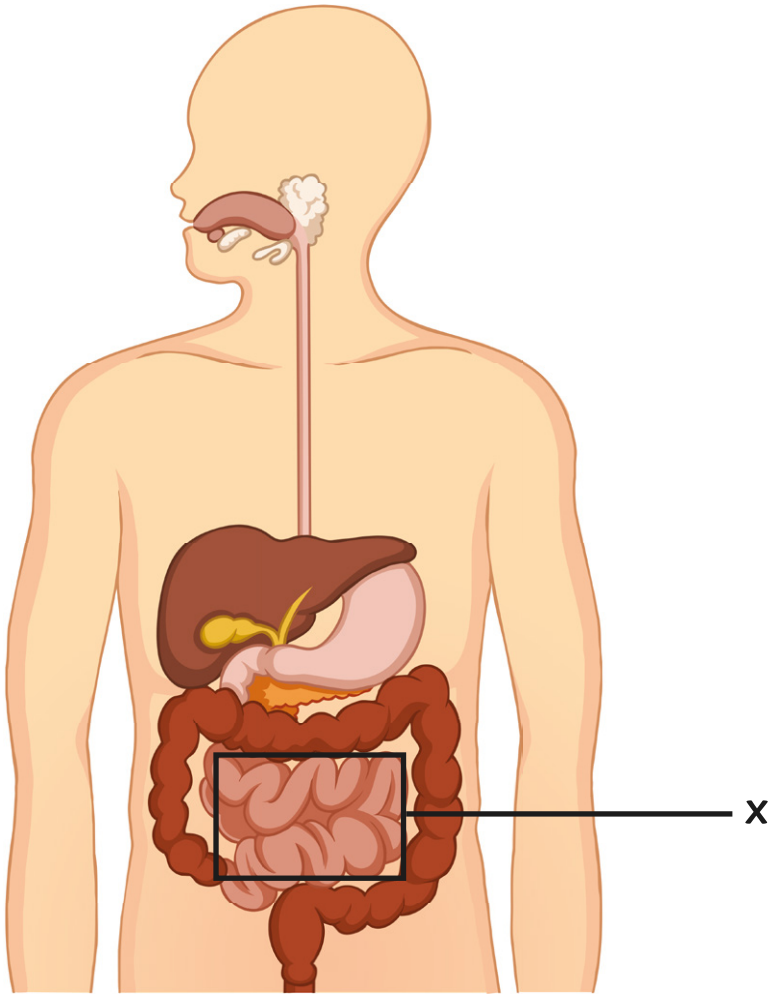
oesophagus

A tube that links the mouth to the stomach.


X

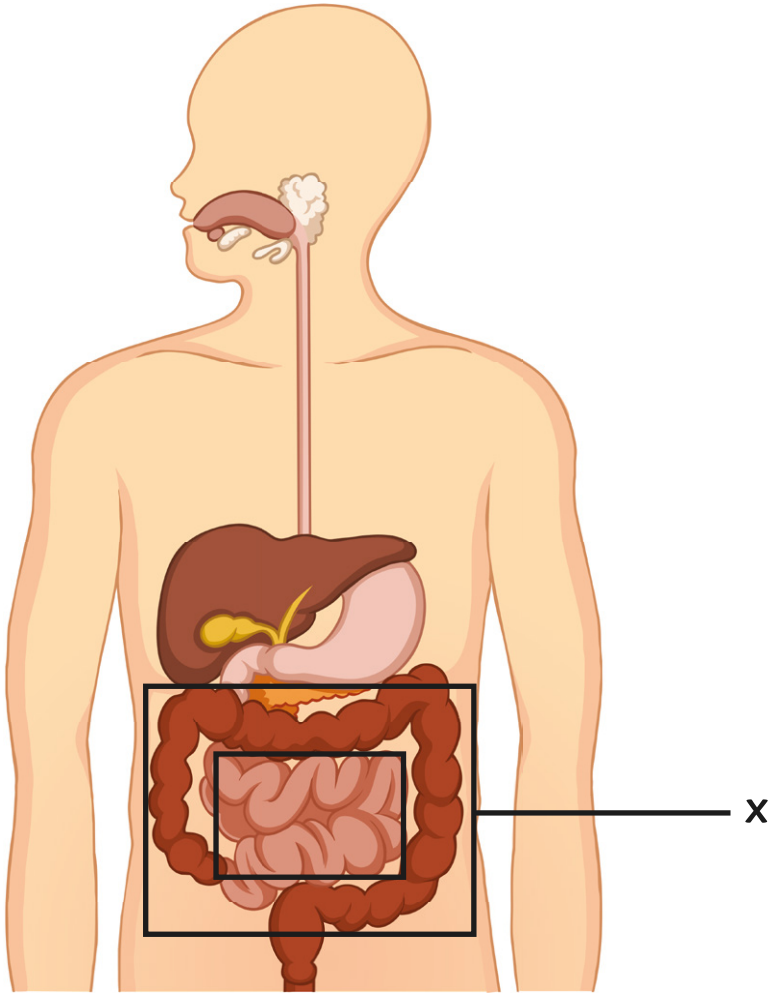
stomach

This is a muscular ‘bag’ that churns and mixes the food with hydrochloric acid (to kill bacteria) and protease (an enzyme) that breaks down proteins into amino acids.


x

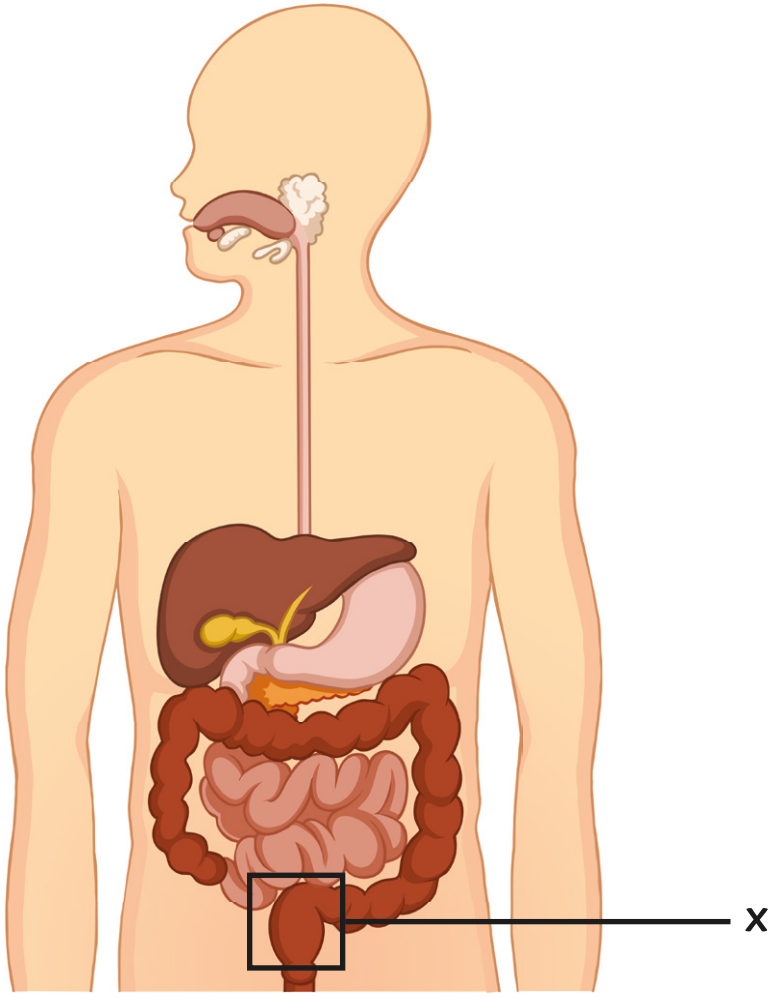
small intestine

This is where lipase (an enzyme) breaks down fats into fatty acids and glycerol and where small, soluble molecules are absorbed into the blood stream.


x

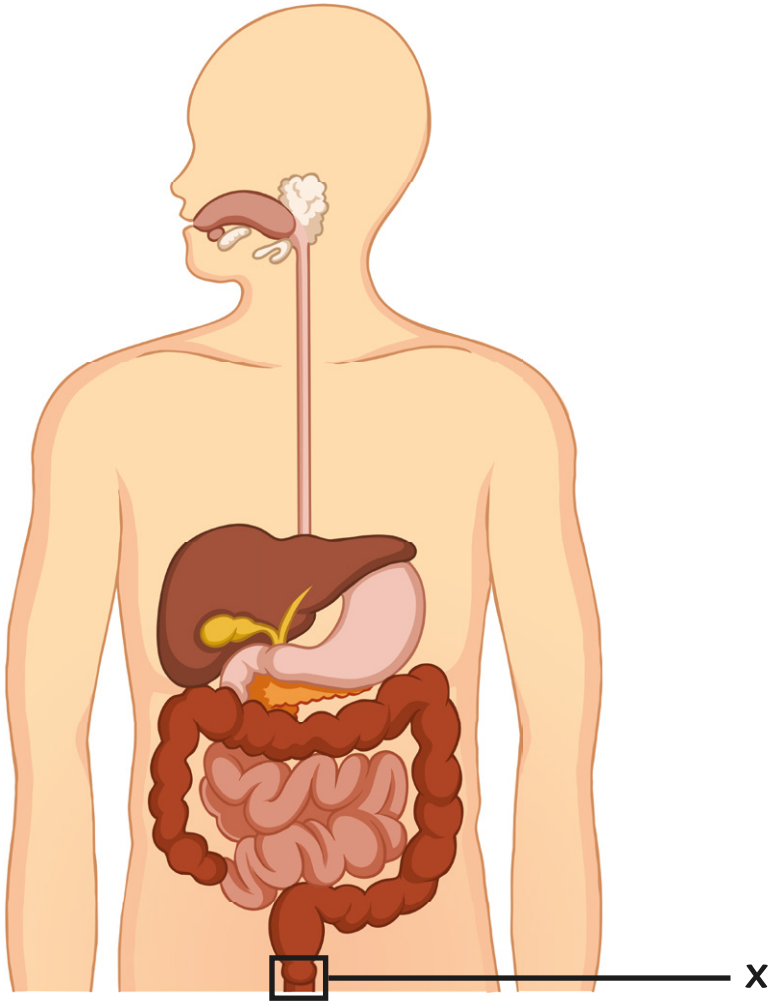
large intestine

This is where water is absorbed into the blood stream.


X

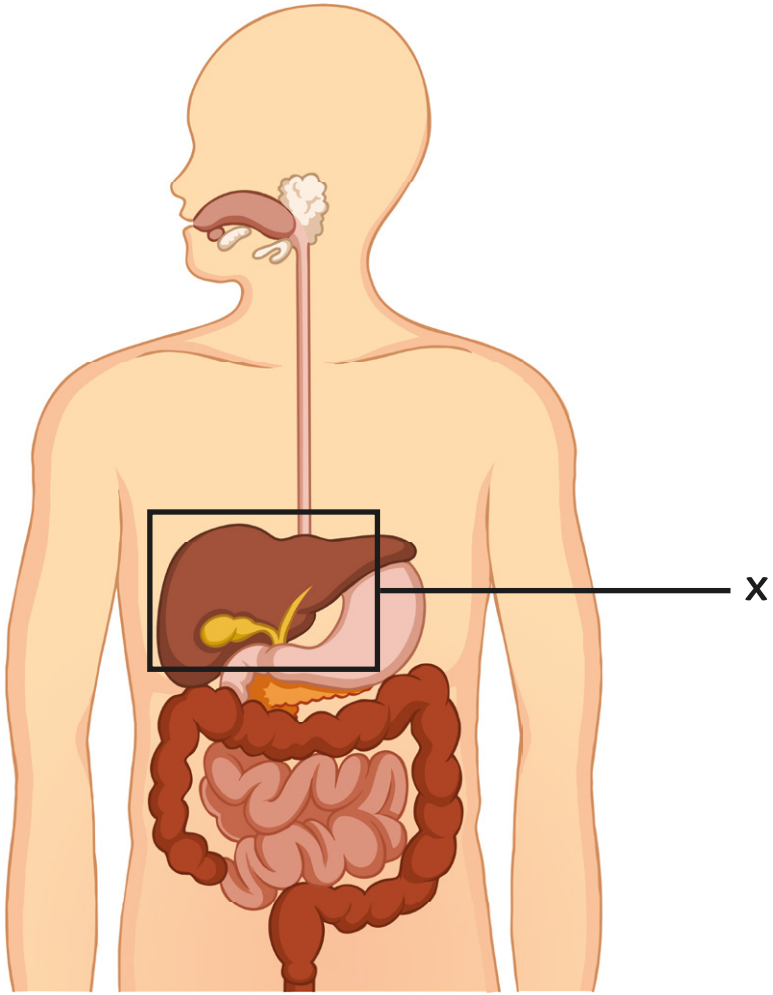
rectum

This is where the undigested food (faeces) is stored until we go to the toilet.


X

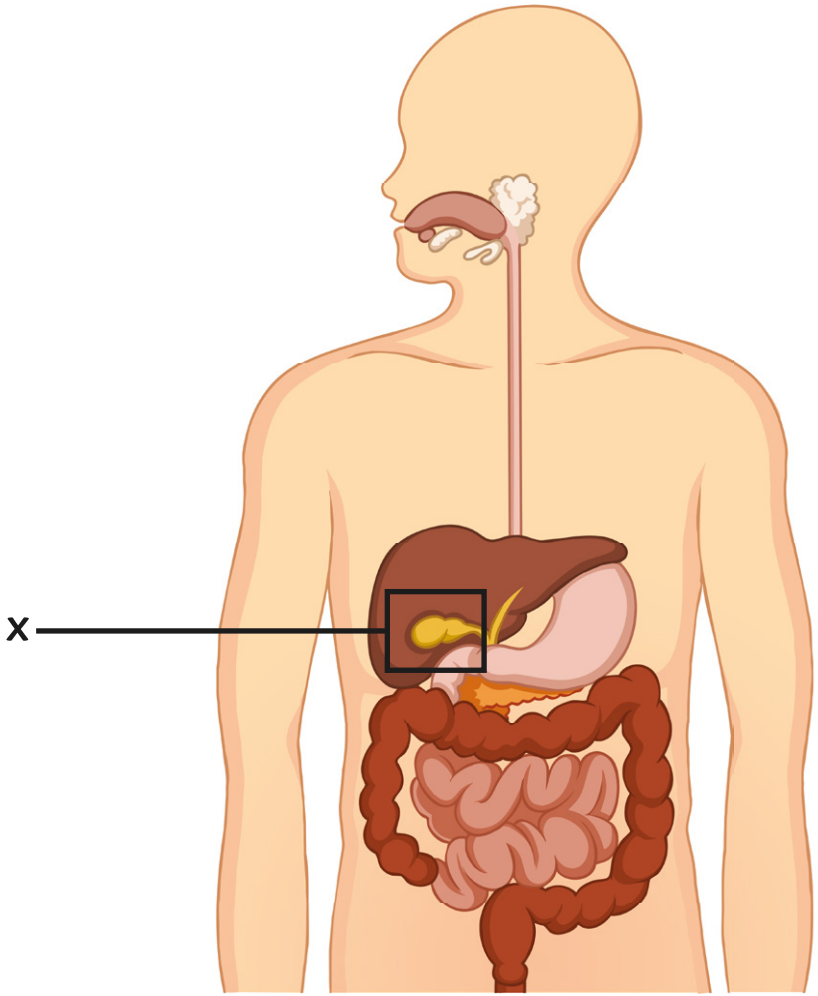
anus

This is a ring of muscle that relaxes to allow faeces to pass out of the body when we go to the toilet (egestion).


x

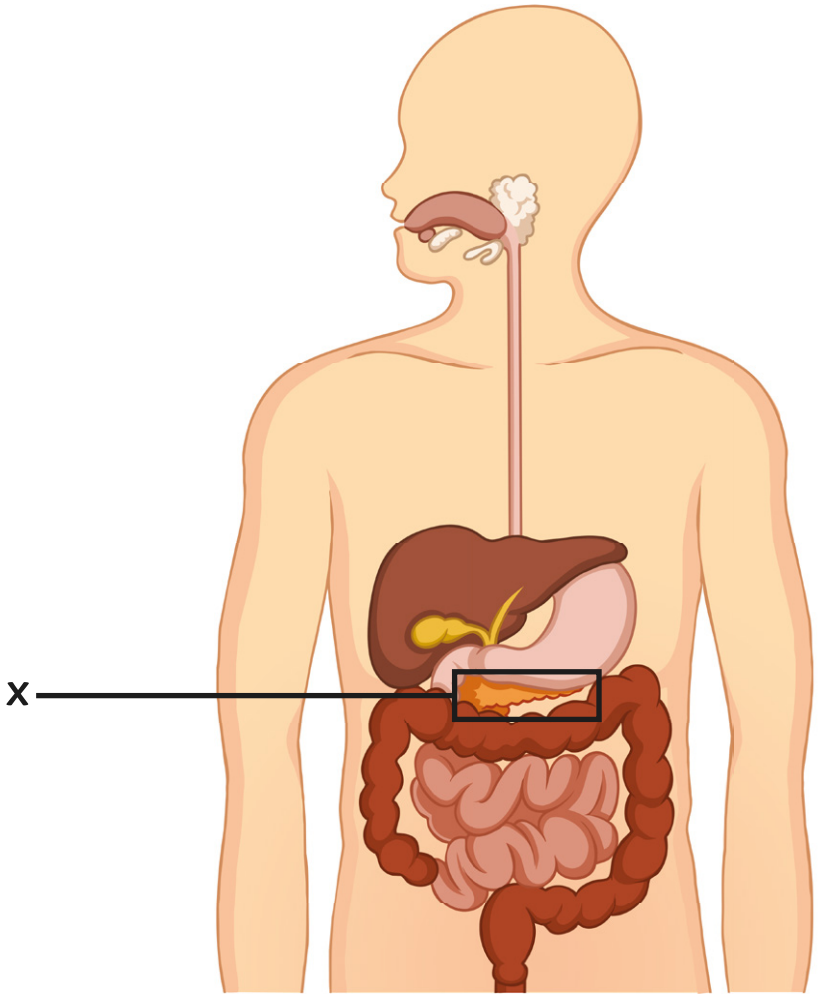
liver

This is where bile is made, which emulsifies fats and helps with their digestion.


X

gall bladder

This is where bile is stored before it is emptied into the small intestine.


X

pancreas

This is where protease, carbohydrase and lipase enzymes are made.